

ACME Widget API 14.3

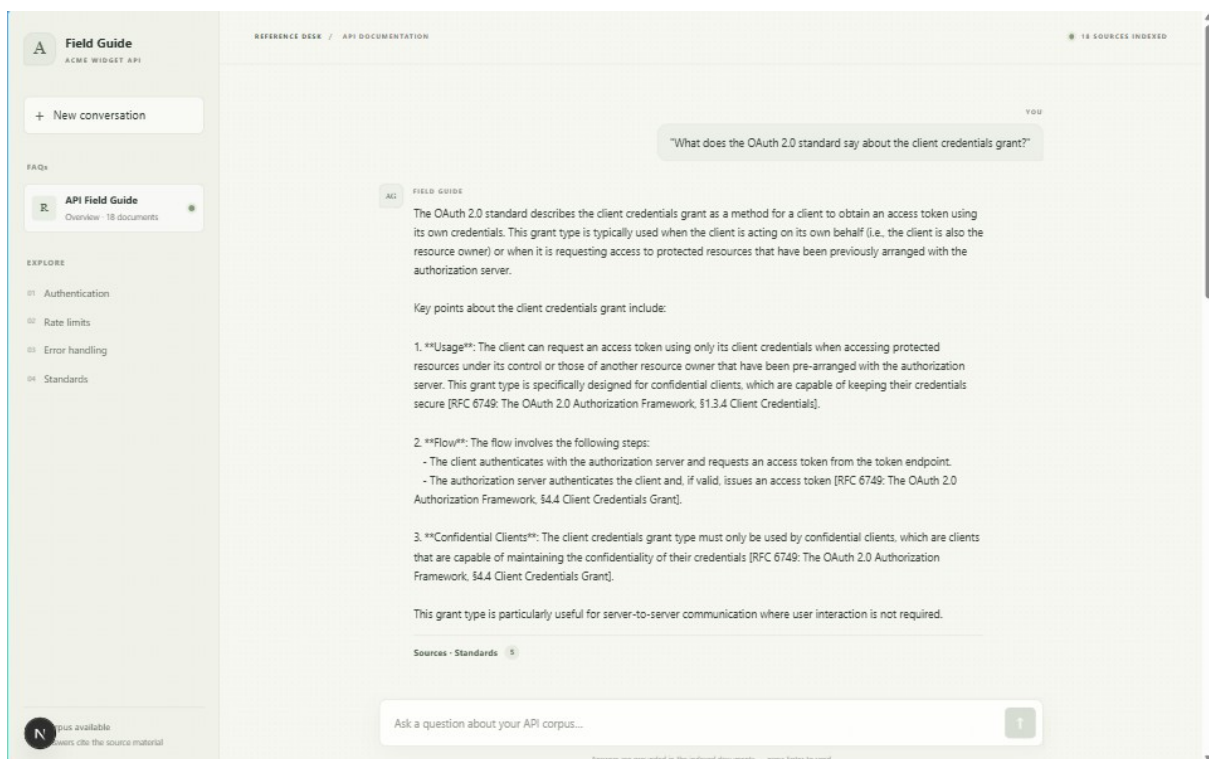
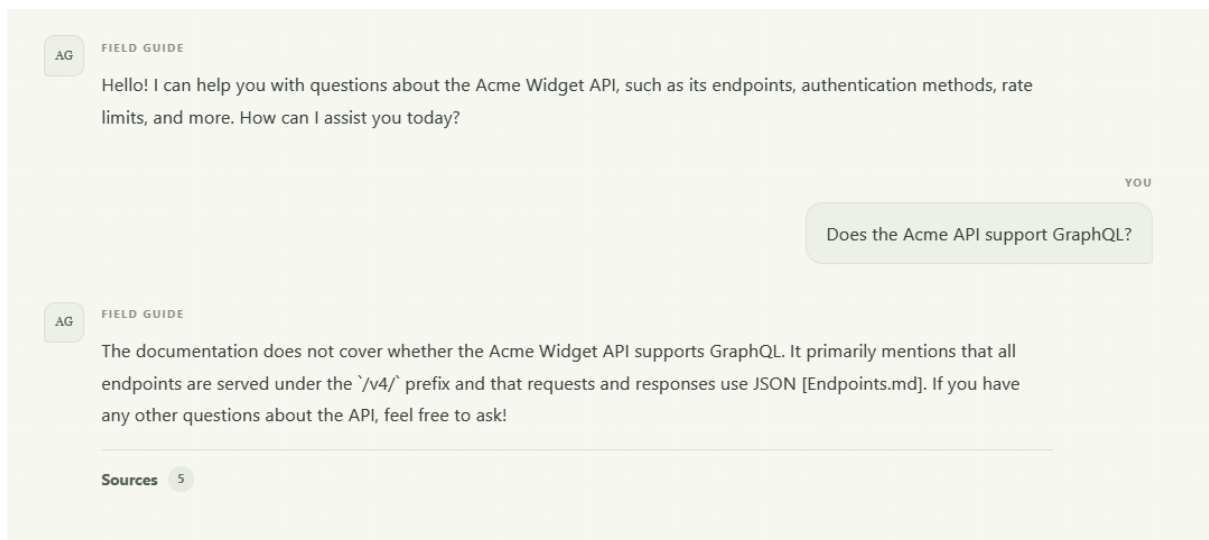
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Course: AIM Postgraduate Artificial Intelligence

Date: 28 Sep 2026

The screenshot shows the ACME Widget API Assistant interface. The browser address bar displays "Not secure 172.19.48.1:3000". The interface includes a sidebar with a "Field Guide" for the "ACME WIDGET API", a "New conversation" button, and a list of documents under "API Field Guide". The main content area displays the results for the query "Acme returns HTTP 429. How does RFC 6585 define it?". The results include a "FIELD GUIDE" section with a summary of RFC 6585, a list of key points (Meaning, Response Details, Server Behavior, Caching), and a code block showing the response headers: "HTTP/1.1 429 Too Many Requests", "Content-Type: text/html", and "Retry-After: 3600". A search bar at the bottom prompts the user to "Ask a question about your API corpus...".

The screenshot shows the ACME Widget API Assistant interface. The browser address bar displays "Not secure 172.19.48.1:3000". The interface includes a sidebar with a "Field Guide" for the "ACME WIDGET API", a "New conversation" button, and a list of documents under "API Field Guide". The main content area displays the results for the query "What does the OAuth 2.0 standard say about the client credentials grant?". The results include a "FIELD GUIDE" section with a summary of the OAuth 2.0 standard, a list of key points (Usage, Flow, Confidential Clients), and a search bar at the bottom prompts the user to "Ask a question about your API corpus...".



Field Guide

ACME WIDGET API

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Framework, §4.4 Client Credentials Grant].

This grant type is particularly useful for server-to-server communication where user interaction is not required.

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YOU

"Is Idempotency-Key an official standard?"

AG

FIELD GUIDE

The Idempotency-Key is not an official standard; it is currently an Internet-Draft, which means it is a work in progress and has not yet been finalized as a standard. The draft outlines how the Idempotency-Key HTTP request header field can be used to make non-idempotent HTTP methods, such as POST or PATCH, fault-tolerant by allowing clients to retry requests safely.

Key points about the Idempotency-Key include:

1. ****Definition****: An idempotency key is a unique value generated by the client that the resource uses to recognize subsequent retries of the same request. The Idempotency-Key header carries this value [draft-ietf-httpapi-idempotency-key-header-07.txt, §2 The Idempotency-Key HTTP Request Header Field].

2. ****Uniqueness****: The idempotency key must be unique and must not be reused with another request that has a different payload. It is recommended to use a UUID or a similar random identifier for this purpose [draft-ietf-httpapi-idempotency-key-header-07.txt, §2.2 Uniqueness of Idempotency Key].

3. ****Usage****: The Idempotency-Key can help ensure that repeated requests do not result in unintended side effects, making it particularly useful in scenarios where network issues may cause clients to retry requests [draft-ietf-httpapi-idempotency-key-header-07.txt, Abstract].

Since it is still a draft, it may undergo changes before becoming an official standard.

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"How do I safely retry a POST /v4/orders request?"

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FIELD GUIDE

To safely retry a 'POST /v4/orders' request, you should follow these steps:

1. ****Use an Idempotency-Key****: Since the 'POST' method is not idempotent, you need to include an 'Idempotency-Key' header with a unique value (such as a UUID) in your request. This key allows the server to deduplicate requests that have the same key within a 24-hour window. If your request times out and you retry it with the same key, the order will only be created once [Endpoints.md, Order Errors and Safe Retries].

Example of the Idempotency-Key header:
...
Idempotency-Key: 5f2b8c1e-7a3d-4e9b-b1c2-9d0e7f6a5b4c
...

2. ****Handle Errors Appropriately****: Be aware of the types of errors that can occur:

- If the request body fails schema validation (e.g., missing 'customer_id'), the API will return error 2002 (validation error).
- If the requested quantity exceeds available inventory, the API will return error 4001 (insufficient stock).
- You should not retry requests that return certain errors (like validation errors) without correcting the request first [Retries_and_Timeouts.md, Idempotency-Key for POST Requests].

3. ****Retry Logic****: Implement a retry mechanism with backoff for handling transient errors. For example, if you receive a 500-series error or a timeout, you can retry the request using the same Idempotency-Key. However, do not retry unchanged requests that return specific errors (like validation errors) without making the necessary corrections [Error_Codes.md, Which Errors Are Worth Retrying].

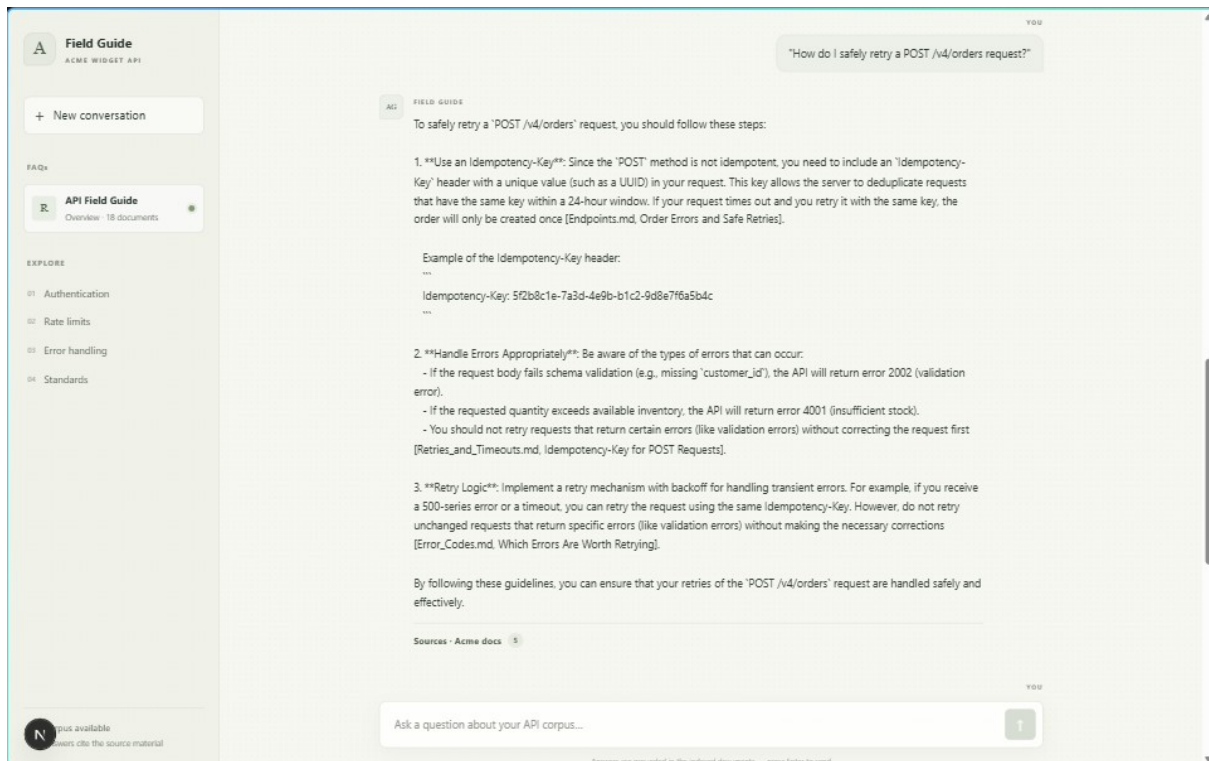
By following these guidelines, you can ensure that your retries of the 'POST /v4/orders' request are handled safely and effectively.

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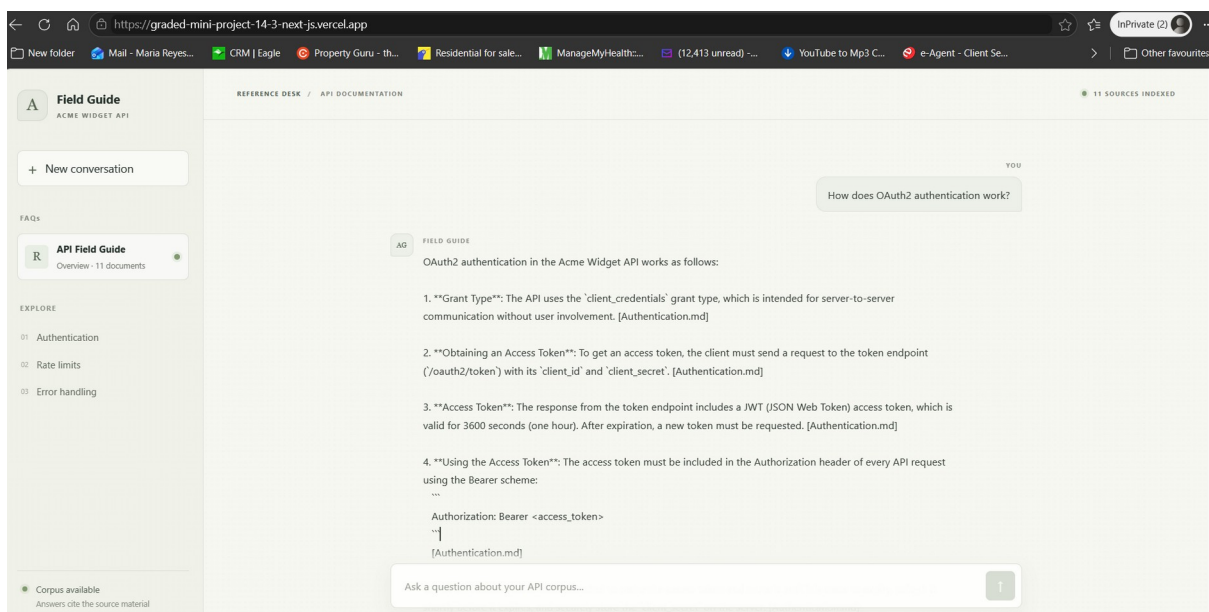
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Sep 27, 2026



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What limits apply to API keys?

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FIELD GUIDE

The limits that apply to API keys in the Acme Widget API are as follows:

1. **Rate Limits**: API key clients are limited to 200 requests per minute, which is significantly lower than the 1000 requests per minute allowed for OAuth2 clients. [Rate_Limits.md]

2. **No Expiration**: API keys do not expire automatically, unlike OAuth2 access tokens, which expire after 3600 seconds. This means that if an API key is leaked, it can be used indefinitely until it is manually revoked. [API_Key_Deprecation_Email.md]

3. **Aggressive Rate Limiting**: API key authentication is rate-limited more aggressively compared to OAuth2, making it less suitable for high-volume applications. [Rate_Limits.md]

If you have any more questions about the Acme Widget API, feel free to ask!

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How should I handle a 429 response?

AG

FIELD GUIDE

To handle a 429 response (Too Many Requests) from the Acme Widget API, you should follow these steps:

1. **Stop Sending Requests**: Immediately cease sending further requests to avoid exacerbating the issue. [Rate_Limits.md]

2. **Read the Retry-After Header**: Check the 'Retry-After' header in the response, which indicates how many seconds you should wait before retrying. [Rate_Limits.md]

3. **Wait**: Pause your requests for at least the duration specified in the 'Retry-After' header. [Rate_Limits.md]

4. **Implement Exponential Backoff with Jitter**: When retrying, use an exponential backoff strategy with jitter to prevent multiple clients from retrying at the same time. This means gradually increasing the wait time between retries and adding some randomness. [Rate_Limits.md]

5. **Monitor Rate Limits**: During normal operation, keep an eye on the 'X-RateLimit-Remaining' header to slow down your requests before reaching the limit. [Rate_Limits.md]

By following these guidelines, you can effectively manage rate limiting and minimize disruptions in your API usage. If you have more questions, feel free to ask!

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